industrial firms that believed they had been harmed by Chinese dumping or WTO-illegal subsidies to complain. In return, the Brazilians believed that they had received a firm promise of very substantial Chinese investment, "up to $50 billion," in many of the same or very similar projects that later figured in the May 2015 package, including an earlier version of the Transoceanic Railway. When these did not materialize, many policymakers and opinion leaders felt duped.[261]

By the end of 2015, both Standard & Poor's (S&P), in September, and Fitch Ratings, in December, had downgraded Brazil's Treasury debt to junk status as well. As the country's macroeconomic problems made it increasingly difficult for even good firms to access international capital in global private markets, the CDB, which had stepped in with a pledge of $3.5 billion for Petrobras in April 2015, increased this amount to $10 billion in January 2016.[262]

The crisis continued, and of course China was unable and unwilling to act as a savior for the Rousseff government. In May 2016, Rousseff, whose popularity had fallen into the single digits, was suspended from office by Brazil's Congress, pending her trial before the Senate on charges of manipulation of public finances, and her impeachment trial concluded with a judgment against her in August. Acting President Michel Temer, representing a coalition of the center-right, took rapid steps to move economic and foreign policies rightward, clearly signaling a downgrading of the BRICS and of South-South diplomacy more generally, in favor of refocusing on ties with the United States and European Union. Nonetheless, the new foreign minister—U.S.-trained economist, senator, and former mayor of São Paulo José Serra—was careful to emphasize that "China and India" remained "key partners."[263] Even if the center-right retains power until the next regularly scheduled election in late 2018, as looks likely, Brazil will continue to participate in the BRICS and in the BRICS' projects. President Temer or his successor might even retain PNB in the position of Brazilian vice president of the NDB (despite having rapidly replaced virtually all other senior economic and political appointees of presidents da Silva and Rousseff). Nonetheless, future BRICS cooperation will be filtered more directly through considerations of Brazil's short- to medium-term commercial and investment interests, and the priority placed on not alienating the United States will be higher. Brazilian leaders will want to hedge their bets with China, the rising economic power, but over the